

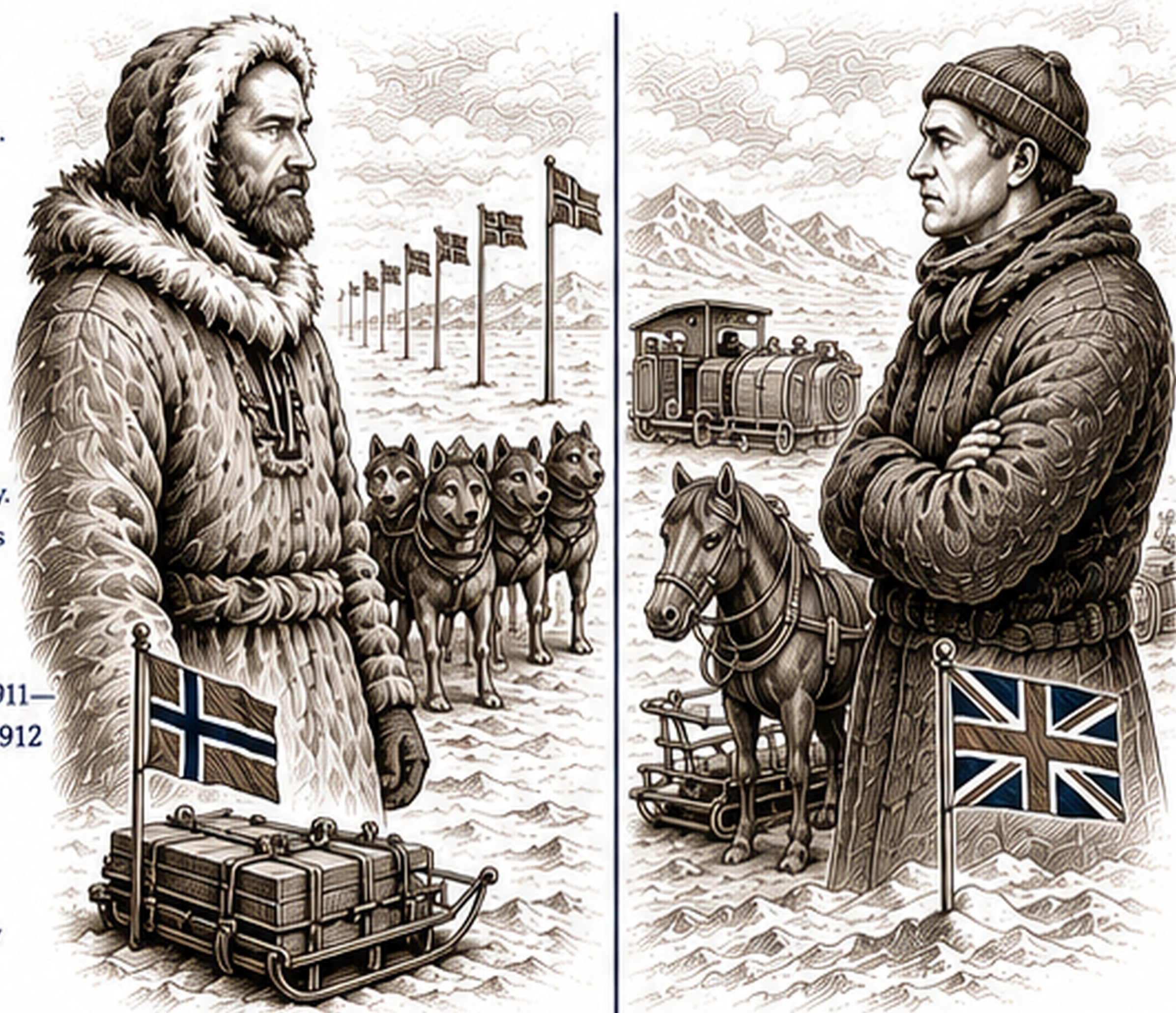
AMUNDSEN vs. SCOTT

SPARKWORKS

Think through anything.

THE RACE WON A YEAR BEFORE IT BEGAN

- ✓ **THE RACE:**
In 1911, two expeditions race to be the first humans to reach the South Pole. Same goal. Same continent. Same year.
- ✓ **THE FAVORITE:**
Robert Scott. Royal Navy captain. British. Government backing. Famous. Wealthy. Prior Antarctic experience.
- ✓ **THE UNDERDOG:**
Roald Amundsen. Norwegian. Less money. Less famous. Lived with Inuit communities to learn polar survival.
- ✓ **THE FINISH:**
Amundsen reaches the Pole December 14, 1911—34 days ahead. Scott arrives January 17, 1912 and finds Amundsen's flag waiting.
- ✓ **THE RETURN:**
All four of Amundsen's men walk home. Scott and his polar party freeze on the way back — 11 miles from a food depot they could not find in a blizzard.



EUREKA MOMENT

Reaction is fast and often wrong. Strategy is slow and usually wins.

STRATEGY IS WHAT YOU DECIDE BEFORE THE GAME STARTS.

1 TRANSPORTATION

Amundsen: 52 sled dogs, trained for snow.

Scott: Ponies and motor sledges. None suited to snow.



DOGS WALKED HOME

2 FOOD DEPOTS

Amundsen: Long flag lines. Markers from every angle.

Scott: Sparse markers. Hard to find in snow.



FOUND THE DEPOT

3 CLOTHING

Amundsen: Loose Inuit fur parkas. Sweat escapes.

Scott: Tight British wool. Soaks, then freezes.



DRY AND WARM

4 PACE

Amundsen: 15 miles every day, good weather or bad.

Scott: Hard on good days. Waited out the bad.



STEADY WINS

→ AMUNDSEN NEVER OUTRAN SCOTT. HE OUT-PLANNED HIM A YEAR EARLIER. ←

AMUNDSEN'S METHOD

1 PLAN

Decide before you act.



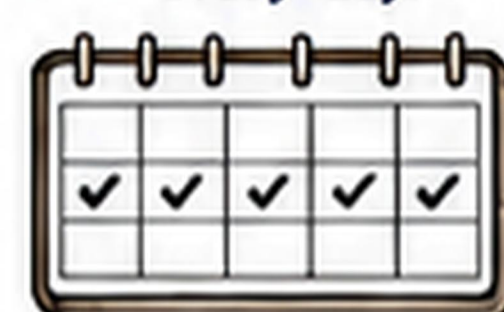
2 PREPARE

Build for the worst day.



3 PACE

Same effort, every day.



4 ADAPT

Re-plan when reality teaches you.



THE REAL LESSON

Amundsen wasn't braver than Scott. He wasn't faster. He wasn't even better in the cold. He just refused to react.

A year before he stepped onto the ice, he was already thinking about the day he'd need to find a food depot in a whiteout.

Scott reacted. Amundsen had strategy.

Great strategists
PLAN BEFOREHAND.



PAUSE
Stop and take a breath.



THINK
Look at the facts. Consider options.



ACT
Choose your move. Then commit.